

Appendix D — Pre-test-day checklist

Actionable lines only. Tick them.

The week before

Confirm with your test centre — these are the ones this book could not settle

Every item here was researched against official sources and could **not** be confirmed. One phone call answers all five.

- **Delivery mode.** Confirm computer-delivered, not IELTS Online. They are different products. *IELTS Online is not accepted for immigration purposes, and institutional acceptance is optional* — at ~TND 750 a sitting, booking the wrong one is an expensive discovery.
- **Keyboard layout — AZERTY or QWERTY?** Published nowhere. If you train on one and sit the other, every minute in your Writing timing plan is optimistic. Ask, then practise on that layout.
- **Speaking: same day or a different day?** For computer-delivered both partners point to same day, but the published scheduling windows disagree with each other. **Trust your booking confirmation over any website.**
- **One Skill Retake — is it available at your centre?** Offered in 110+ countries, but no official page names a Tunisian centre. Do not treat it as your safety net until someone confirms it.
- **Pen or pencil?** The British Council's policy page bans personal stationery; Cambridge's FAQ says you may write in pen or pencil. Follow whatever your centre tells you on the day.

Admin

- ID booked with = ID you will carry. **The same document**, not an equivalent one.
- Booking confirmation saved offline — screenshot it, don't rely on signal.
- Test centre address checked, and the journey timed at the same hour of day.
- Fee paid and receipt kept (TND, Academic ~750).

Preparation

- At least one **full timed** Listening + Reading sitting completed back-to-back, no pausing, typed answers, 2-minute check only.
- At least one **full 60-minute** Writing mock, both tasks, typed, on your test keyboard layout.
- Your last three /review sessions read again — the recurring patterns, not the individual errors.
- `handbook.md` regenerated and read once.

- Recorded yourself on a Part 2 and listened back for the three named features: **speech rate, stress-timing, chunking**.

The night before

- No new material. Nothing you learn tonight will be retrievable tomorrow.
 - Reread only: this appendix, `CHEAT-SHEETS.md`, and your own error card (Appendix C).
 - Bag packed: ID, booking confirmation, water, layers.
 - Alarm set with a backup.
 - **Sleep**. Fatigue destroys Writing accuracy first, and accuracy is where band 7 is decided.
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Test day

Arrival

- Arrive early. No official page publishes an arrival time — assume 30 minutes and confirm with your centre.
- Expect ID check, photograph, and biometrics.
- Phone off and stowed. A phone that sounds can void your test.

Listening — ~30 minutes

- Use every second of reading time to **predict**: type of word, singular or plural, and two or three candidate answers per gap.
- Type as you listen. 🖨️ **No transfer time. 2 minutes to check.**
- **One answer per gap**. Two scores zero even when one is right.
- Answers come in order — for every question type. Miss one, move forward. Hunting backwards turns one lost mark into three.
- Never a blank. A guess costs nothing.
- The 2 minutes are for **spelling and plurals only** — not for reconsidering, which usually makes answers worse.

Reading — 60 minutes, no transfer time

- Hard stops: about 20 minutes per passage. Obey them even mid-question.
- Matching Headings early. Matching Information last.
- 🖨️ **Copy-paste from the passage** for completion answers — it makes spelling errors structurally impossible. **CTRL+F does not work**.
- True/False/Not Given: *can I point at the sentence that contradicts this?* If not → **NOT GIVEN**. Do not reflex-guess it; decide from what you read.
- Never a blank.

Writing — 60 minutes

- **Task 2 first if you tend to run out of time.** It is worth double.
- Task 1: stop writing at **17 minutes**, check to 20.
- Task 2: 5 minutes planning, stop writing at **37 minutes**, check to 40.
- Underline **every part** of the Task 2 question before planning. A half-answered question is an automatic band 6 on Task Response.
- Task 1: write the **overview** first if you must. Without it, Task Achievement is capped.
- Paraphrase the prompt. **Copied rubric is discounted before your words are counted.**
- Check the on-screen word count. Do not estimate it.
- Final 3 minutes: proofread for **your** errors, in this order — **articles** (and the counter-list), **uncountables** (*informations, researches*), **third-person -s, run-ons**.
- Delete and repair. **Never add** in the final pass.

Speaking — 11-14 minutes

- Warm your voice up: ten minutes of English aloud beforehand.
- Part 1: two or three sentences per answer. Answer + reason + example.
- Part 2: the prep minute is for **keywords, not sentences**. Reading aloud from notes flattens delivery and costs Fluency and Pronunciation.
- Speak the full two minutes. Being stopped **means you spoke long enough**.
- Part 3: expect pushback. Concede what is fair, then hold your ground with a reason. That is what is being tested.
- Don't know a word? **Paraphrase**. That is a band-7 move, not a failure.
- Slow down. A rapid speech rate is named at band 6 as damaging your rhythm.

When you get stuck

One rule per paper. Use it and move.

Paper	The rule
Listening	Guess and move forward. Never chase backwards.
Reading	Hard stop. Next passage. Come back if time allows.
Writing T1	Write the overview, then the two body paragraphs.
Writing T2	Answer the question that was actually asked.
Speaking	Answer, reason, example. Then stop.

One bad section does not decide your band. The average of four does. A 5.5 in one paper survives if the other three hold.

Afterwards

- Results: plan against **5 days** (roughly half arrive within 1 day, 80% within 2, but official pages range up to 5).
- If one skill falls short, ask about **One Skill Retake** — availability at your centre still unconfirmed.
- **Enquiry on Results: apply within six weeks** of the test date. Fee refunded if a band changes. Only IDP states a score cannot fall; the other partners are silent — check your centre's terms before assuming a re-mark is risk-free.
- Scores are valid for two years.